# Story of the Flood (*Atraḫasīs*) – Middle Babylonian Priv: ""Wall, Wall! Reed Fence, Reed Fence!"

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- Source: eBL corpus – https://www.ebl.lmu.de/corpus/L/1/1/Middle%20Babylonian/Priv
- API: https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/1/chapters/Middle%20Babylonian/Priv/display
- Edition:
- Translation:
- Generated by `tools/ebl_fetch.py` on 2026-10-16 – do not edit by hand; re-run the tool instead.

Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (`|` metrical foot, `||` caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

## 1

- **N:** [i]gār | igā[r] || [k]ikkiš | kikkiš
- **T:** "Wall, wall! Reed fence, reed fence!

```
BabaMB1 o 1. [i]-ga-ar i-ga-a[r k]i-ki-iš ki-ki-iš
```

## 2-3

- **N:** atramhasīs | ana milkīya | qūl-[ma] || taballuṭ | [d]āriš
- **T:** "Atra-ḫasīs, pay attention to my advice, that you live forever!

```
BabaMB1 o 2-3. {m}at-ra-am-ha-si#-[i]s* a-na# mi-il-ki-ia qu₂-ul-[ma] | ta-ba-al
```

## 4a

- **N:** ubut | bītam || bini | eleppam
- **T:** “Destroy (your) house, build a boat;
- **Note:** On the interpretation of *u₂-bu-ut*, see the commentary on OB III 21.

```
BabaMB1 o 4a. u₂-bu-ut E₂ bi-ni MA₂
```

## 4b-5

- **N:** m[a]kkūram | zē[r-ma] || napištam | šullim
- **T:** “Spurn property, save life!

```
BabaMB1 o 4b-5. m[a-a]k-ku-ra-am ze-e[r-ma] | na#-pi₂-iš-tam# šu-ul#-lim
```

## 6-7

- **N:** elep (|) teppušu | e[ṣ]erší-ma || eṣerti | k[i]ppātim
- **T:** “The boat which you will build, draw it out as a circular plan.
- **Note:** The interpretation of *e*[*ṣ*]*erší-ma* as an imperative follows [RN3182: 299]: *“Draw out the boat that you will make/ On a circular plan”*. We take *eṣerti k*[*i*]*ppātim* as a predicative complement (on this category, see the comment on OB I 1). [wasserman2020flood: 69] understands *e*[*ṣ*]*erší-ma* as a first person, but also takes *e-*[*ṣ*]*e-er-ti ki-*[*i*]*p-pa-tim* as a predicative.

```
BabaMB1 o 6-7. MA₂ te-ep-pu-šu e-[ṣ]e-er-ši-ma | e-[ṣ]e-er-ti ki-[i]p-pa-tim
```

## 8

- **N:** lū mithār | šidda[š]a | u pū[ssa]
- **T:** “Her length should be equal to its breadth,

```
BabaMB1 o 8. lu mi-it-ha-ar ši-id-da-[š]a u₃ pu-u[s-sa]
```

## 9

- **N:** lū ištēn (|) ikûm | kaqqarša || lū ištēn (|) nindanum | ig[ārātūša]
- **T:** “Her base should be one *ikû* (ca. 60 m²); [her] hull (lit. walls) should be one *nindanu* (ca. 7 m) (high).

```
BabaMB1 o 9. lu-u₂ 1 IKU ka-aq-qa₂-ar-š[a lu]-u₂# 1 NINDA# i-g[a-ra-tu-ša]
```

## 10

- **N:** kannū | ašlā || <lū> ṭamû | [ina lib]bīša
- **T:** <Let> the cords – each one *ašlu* long – be woven [*inside*] it.
- **Note:** Compare the reading of this line suggested by Finkel in his edition of the fragment ([RN1780: 359]): *ka-an-nu aš-la-a ta-mu-u[r] ša [MA₂]*, “You saw *kannu* ropes and *ašlu* ropes/rushes for [a coracle before!].” The reading is problematic, as it would result in *kannu* used for the accusative, as noted by [RN2399: 253 fn. 6] or as *casus pendens*, in the interpretation of [streck2017review: 140] (“Ropes, each (one) *ašlu* long – (when) you have found (them) for [the ship(?)], then may somebody twist …”). [george2016review: 445] suggests reading *ka-an-nu aš-la-a <lu> ṭa₂-mu-u₂# [a-na ŠA₃]-ša₂*, “[Let] tapes, each 120 cubits long, be laced [inside] it.” [wasserman2020flood: 71] follows this reading, though he notes that *ṭam/wû* is unusual when referring to the preparation of ropes, as this verb virtually always refers to wool, textiles and braids (but note *ušandû ana gišparrīšu iṭammi ebla*, “The bird hunter plaits strands for his snare,” in *Palm and Vine* 21′; @url{/corpus/L/2/12}{L II.12}). All three interpreters note that *ašlu* is a measure of length making 10 *nindanum*, ca. 60 m. [streck2017review: 140] explains that the distributive suffix *-ā* (*ašlā*) indicates that each and every one of the *kannu*-cords must reach this length.

```
BabaMB1 o 10. ka-an-nu aš-la-a <lu> ṭa₂-mu-u₂# [i-na ŠA₃]-ša
```

## 11

- **N:** liptilkum | bītī | pi[t]ilt[am]
- **T:** “Let my temple (personnel) twist the fibers into a rope for you
- **Note:** For the interpretation of this line, see [george2016review: 445], who suggests reading the middle word as *E₂{+bi-ti}*, i.e., *bītī*: “Let my household plait the palm fibre into ropes for you.” George interprets this as Ea offering his temple personnel to help Atram-ḫasīs construct the boat. See also [wasserman2020flood: 72]. Compare the different interpretation offered in [RN1780: 359]: *li-ip-ti-ik-kum GIŠ ar₂#-ti pi₂-[t]i-il-tam*, “Let someone (else) twist the fronds and palm-fibre for you!”

```
BabaMB1 o 11. li-ip-ti-il-kum E₂{+bi-ti} pi₂-[t]i-il-t[am]
```